

Massachusetts Immunization Information System (MIIS)

Fact Sheet for Patients

The MIIS is a statewide initiative to track immunizations for you and your children. Immunizations that are tracked include the flu, measles, chickenpox, tetanus, and other diseases. The goal is to keep up-to-date and accessible vaccine records for physicians, schools, or in case of a medical emergency.

What is the MIIS, and how will it help me?

- A repository of basic immunization information for people who live in Massachusetts.
- A secure and confidential system for appropriate medical use for people of all ages, not just children.
- Helps you and your family get the care you deserve wherever you go for your healthcare.
- Makes sure that you and your children don't miss any shots or get too many.
- Allows you to print a vaccine record when you need it (i.e. new physician, child starts school or camp).

Why is this important?

Vaccines can be complicated and can require multiple administrations to be effective. The MIIS:

- Helps your healthcare provider keep track of which shots are due and when they should be given.
- Keeps your immunization records together for you, your family, and your healthcare provider.
- Prevents outbreaks of disease like measles and the flu in your community.
- Keeps shot records safe during natural disasters such as flooding or hurricanes.

What information is kept in the MIIS, and how is it collected?

- Information is sent to the MIIS system when a child is born or when a child gets his or her first shots.
- Your healthcare provider can add your records or your family's records if they are not already in the MIIS.
- A list of shots that you or your children have received as well as any that you or your children will need to get in the future.
- Information needed for safe and accurate immunization of each patient, such as name, date of birth, gender, mother's maiden name (for children), address, phone number, and provider office where each shot is given.

Who has access to my records?

The Department of Public Health (DPH) uses modern technology to make sure that all information entered into the MIIS is kept secure and confidential. The information in the MIIS is only available to:

- Healthcare providers or others ensuring appropriate immunization, as authorized by DPH.
- Schools and local boards of health.
- DPH, including the WIC program, and other state agencies or programs that provide education and outreach about vaccines to their clients.
- Public health research specially approved by the Commissioner of Public Health.

What if I don't want to participate?

- If you opt out you need to ask your provider for the "Objection or Withdrawal of Objection to Data Sharing" form.
- If you opt out, doctors, schools, and Emergency Rooms will not have access to the complete record of shots.
- If you choose to share information, only your current healthcare provider will be able to see the shots they have given to you or your children at that location of care.

How can I get more information?

Visit the MIIS website at www.mass.gov/dph/miis, call MIIS directly at 617-983-6800 or 888-658-2850, or ask your healthcare provider for more information.

Patient Name

Parent/Guardian Name

Patient Date of Birth

Signature